Optional practice quizzes and course grades: a three-year prospective cohort study using learning-platform logs

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Abstract

We followed 4,906 students over three academic years and linked their use of optional practice quizzes to course grades. Each additional quiz completed was associated with a 0.6-point higher grade.

1. Methods

Design: prospective cohort study. Participants: 4,906 students enrolled in 22 first-year courses between 2020 and 2023. Exposure: number of optional practice quizzes completed, taken from learning-platform logs. Outcome: final course grade (0-100), adjusted for prior GPA, course and term.

2. Results

Each additional practice quiz completed was associated with a 0.6-point higher course grade (95% CI 0.4 to 0.8) after adjustment.

3. Limitations

Students chose whether to use the quizzes, so the association may reflect motivation or prior ability that the adjustment did not capture. The design is observational and cannot establish causation.

Fictional paper generated to test evidence-table extraction. Authors, journal, data and results are invented.